Alexa Sump Pump Monitor

Alexa & SinricPro Setup Guide

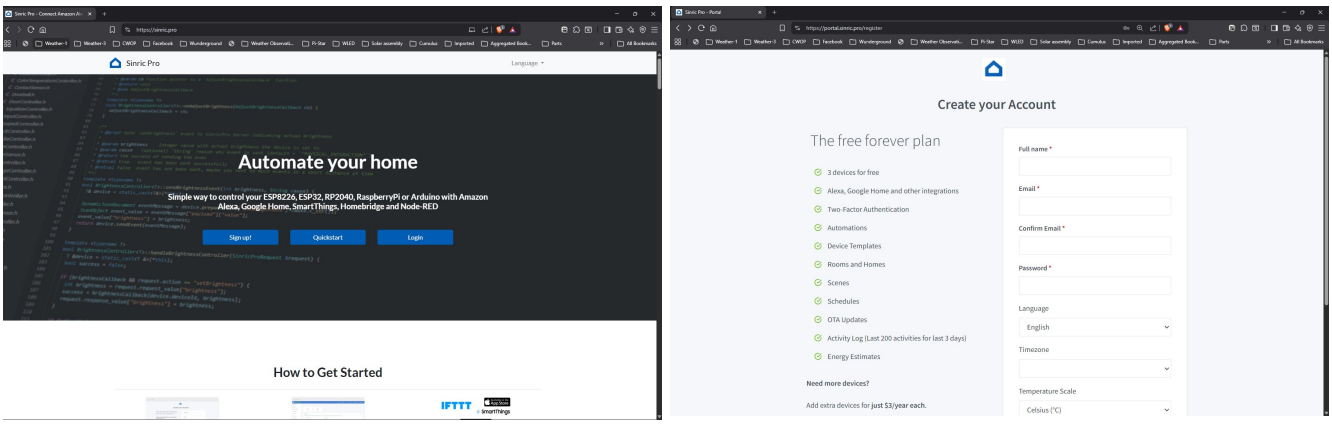
This guide covers the complete setup of the Alexa and SinricPro components of the Sump Pump Monitor project. When the FLOODING sensor is triggered, Alexa announces an alert and plays an alarm sound across all Echo devices. This is an open-source project — source code and full documentation are available at: **https://github.com/Tech500/Sump-Monitor**

Component	Details
Virtual Sensors	FLOODING, HIGHWATER, ALLCLEAR (via SinricPro)
Echo Devices	4 Alexa devices — all used for announcements
Active Routine	FLOODING — single alert routine
Alert Actions	Set Volume → Play Claxion3 alarm → Announce message
My Media	Required to play Claxion3.mp3 alarm sound

Section 1 — SinricPro: Create Account

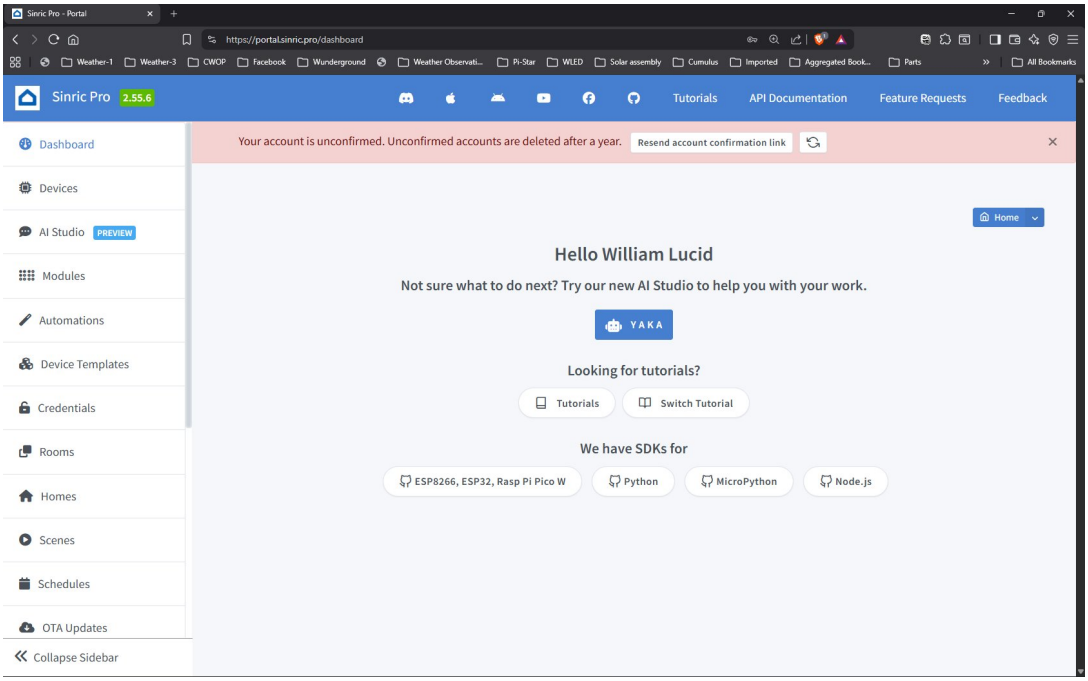
SinricPro provides the virtual contact sensors that bridge your sump pump hardware to Alexa. Create a free account at **sinric.pro**. The free plan includes **3 devices** — exactly what this project needs. Additional devices are available at **$3.00 per device per year**.

- Open a browser and go to **https://sinric.pro**
- Click **Sign up!** to create a new account.



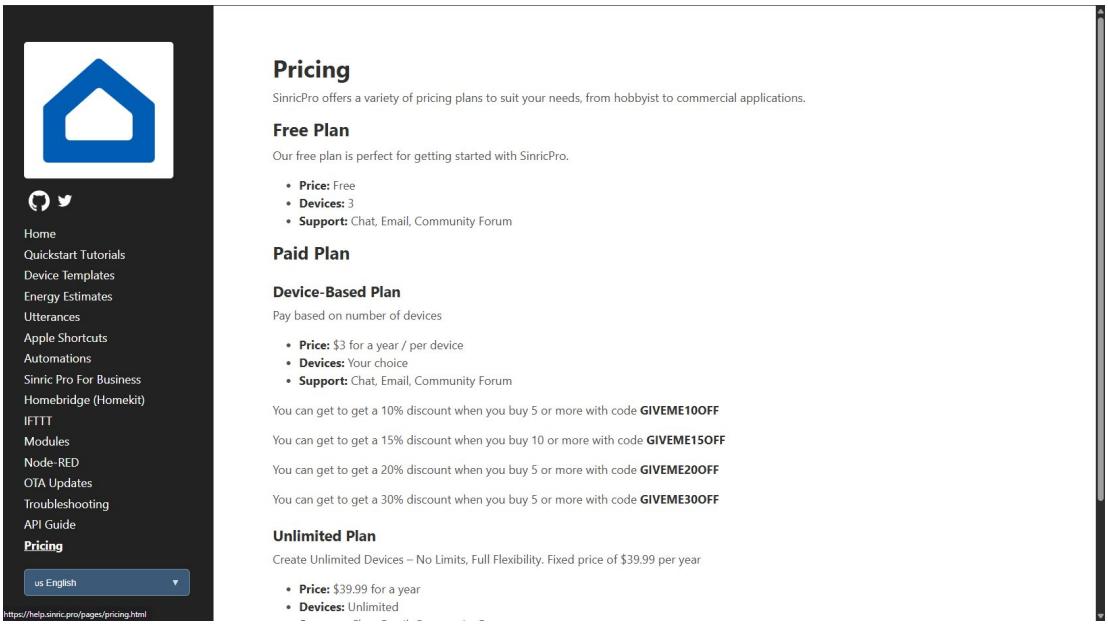
Left: SinricPro landing page. Right: Create Account — free plan includes 3 devices.

- Fill in your Full Name, Email, and Password then click **Create Account**.
- Check your email and confirm your account when prompted.
- Log in — you will see the SinricPro Dashboard.



SinricPro Dashboard after first login.

SinricPro Pricing



Home
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Device Templates
Energy Estimates
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Automations
Sinric Pro For Business
Homebridge (Homekit)
IFTTT
Modules
Node-RED
OTA Updates
Troubleshooting
API Guide
Pricing

us English

https://help.sinric.pro/pages/pricing.html

Pricing

SinricPro offers a variety of pricing plans to suit your needs, from hobbyist to commercial applications.

Free Plan

Our free plan is perfect for getting started with SinricPro.

- **Price:** Free
- **Devices:** 3
- **Support:** Chat, Email, Community Forum

Paid Plan

Device-Based Plan

Pay based on number of devices

- **Price:** $3 for a year / per device
- **Devices:** Your choice
- **Support:** Chat, Email, Community Forum

You can get to get a 10% discount when you buy 5 or more with code **GIVEME10OFF**

You can get to get a 15% discount when you buy 10 or more with code **GIVEME15OFF**

You can get to get a 20% discount when you buy 5 or more with code **GIVEME20OFF**

You can get to get a 30% discount when you buy 5 or more with code **GIVEME30OFF**

Unlimited Plan

Create Unlimited Devices – No Limits, Full Flexibility. Fixed price of $39.99 per year

- **Price:** $39.99 for a year
- **Devices:** Unlimited

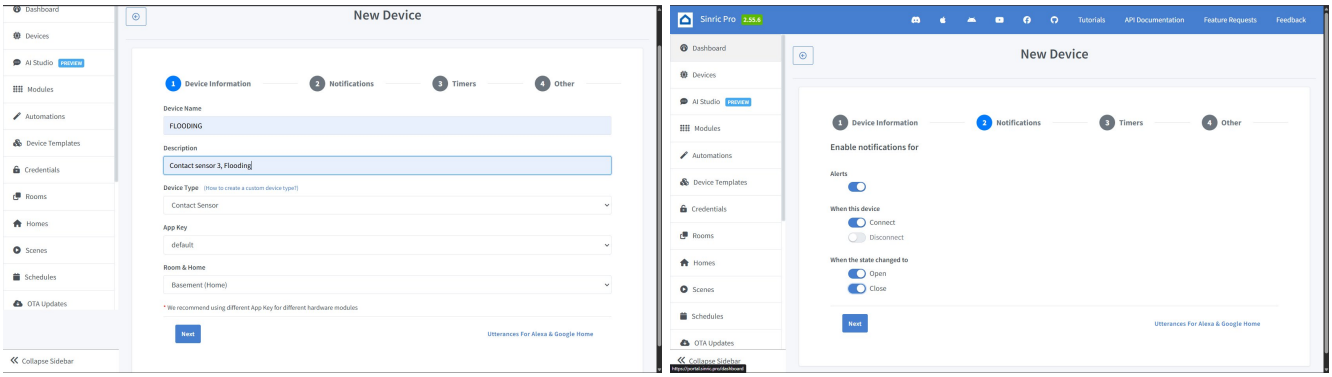
SinricPro pricing — Free plan covers this project. Paid per-device plan available.

■ *This project uses exactly 3 sensors (FLOODING, HIGHWATER, ALLCLEAR) — perfectly within the free tier. No payment required to get started.*

Section 2 — SinricPro: Add Virtual Sensors

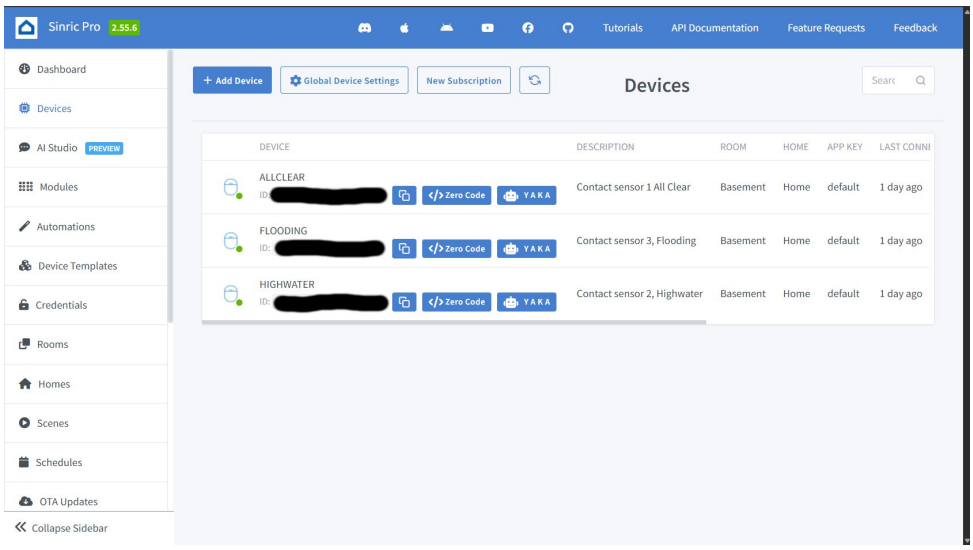
Add three Contact Sensor devices in SinricPro. These names must match exactly as they will be referenced in Alexa routines.

- In the SinricPro dashboard click **Devices** → **Add Device**.
- Enter Device Name: **FLOODING** | Device Type: **Contact Sensor**
- Add a description e.g. "Contact sensor 3, Flooding" then click **Next**.



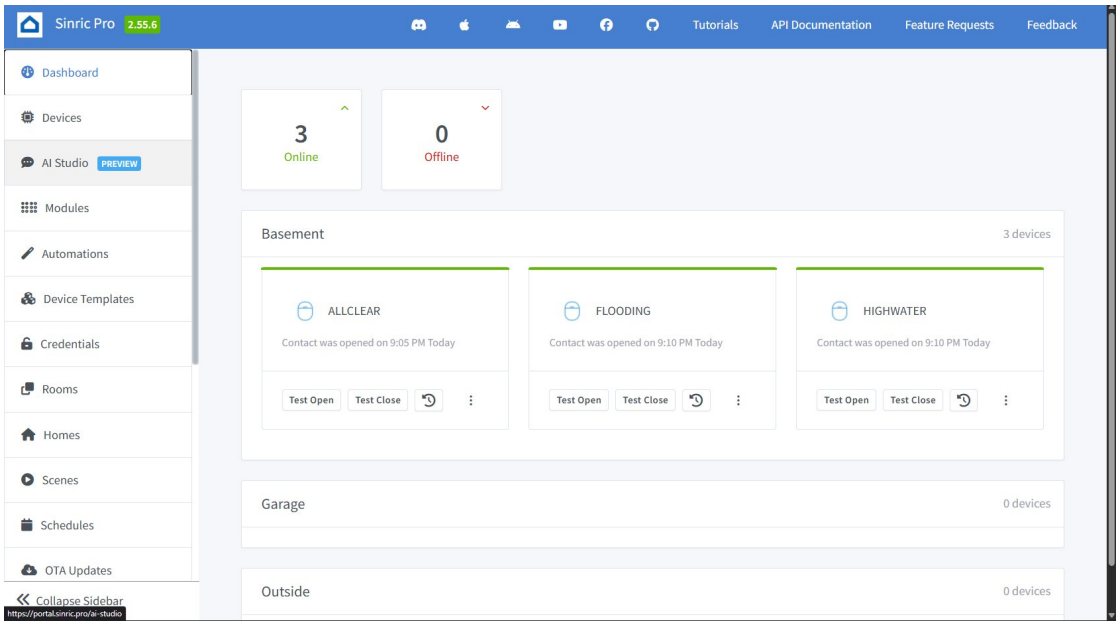
Left: New Device — Device Information. Right: Notifications settings.

- Repeat to add **HIGHWATER** and **ALLCLEAR** contact sensors.
- All three sensors will appear in the Devices list when complete.



Devices list showing ALLCLEAR, FLOODING and HIGHWATER — IDs redacted for security.

■ *Your Device IDs will be unique to your SinricPro account. Keep your App Key and App Secret secure — they are needed by the hardware firmware.*

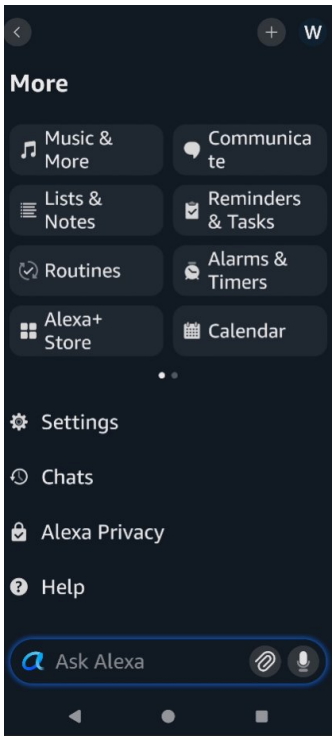


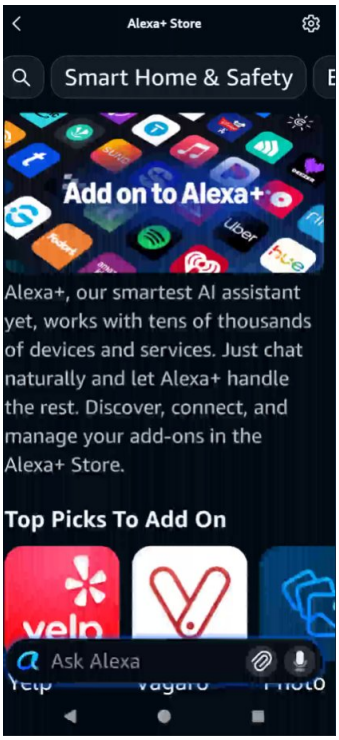
SinricPro Dashboard showing all 3 sensors online (green).

Section 3 — Alexa App: Enable Skills

Two Alexa skills must be enabled before devices can be discovered: **SinricPro** (links your virtual sensors) and **My Media** (plays the Claxion3 alarm sound).

- Open the **Alexa app** on your phone.
- Tap **More** (bottom right navigation bar).
- Tap **Alexa+ Store**.

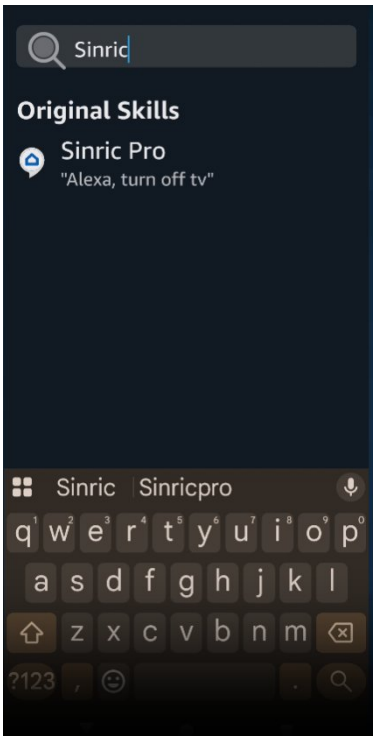




Left: More menu — tap Alexa+ Store. Right: Alexa+ Store.

3.1 Enable SinricPro Skill

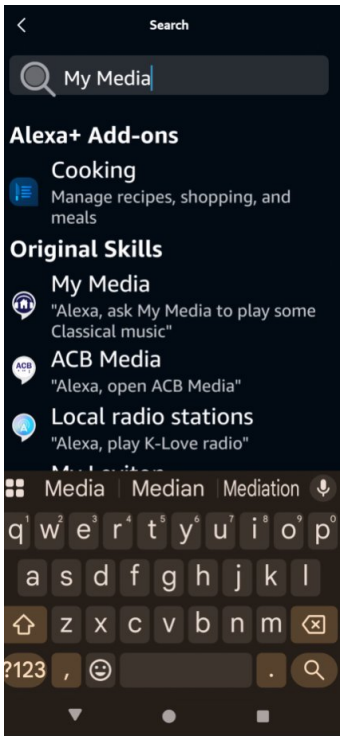
- In the Alexa+ Store tap the **Search** icon and type **SinricPro**.
- Tap **Sinric Pro** from the results.
- Tap **Enable** and sign in with your SinricPro credentials to link your account.



Alexa+ Store search showing Sinric Pro skill.

3.2 Enable My Media Skill

- In the Alexa+ Store search for **My Media**.
- Tap **My Media** from Original Skills results.
- Tap **Enable** — My Media links to your local Raspberry Pi server.
- For My Media Raspberry Pi installation see: **https://www.mymediaalexa.com/home/raspberrypi**



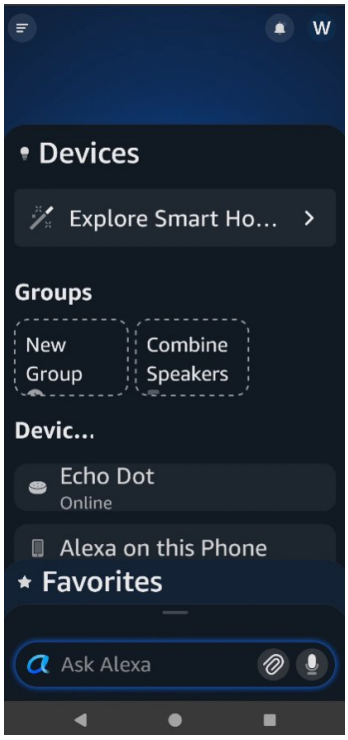
Alexa+ Store search showing My Media skill under Original Skills.

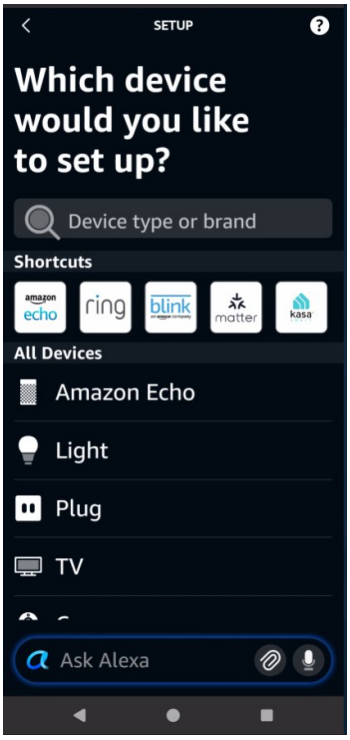
■ *My Media requires a local server running on a Raspberry Pi for 24/7 operation. The Pi is strongly recommended — low power draw, runs cool, and with Docker Compose it is a true set-and-forget installation.*

Section 4 — Alexa App: Discover Devices

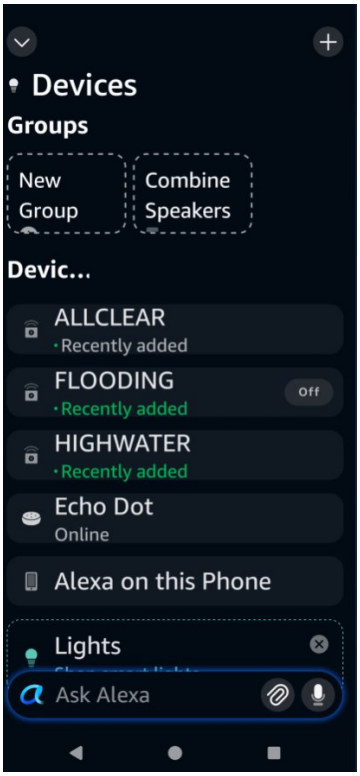
Once the SinricPro skill is enabled and linked, Alexa can discover your virtual sensors.

- In the Alexa app tap **Devices** (bottom navigation bar).
- Tap the **+ (plus)** icon top right → **Add Device**.
- On the "Which device would you like to set up?" screen scroll down and tap **Other** (or use the search bar).
- Tap **Discover Devices** — Alexa will find FLOODING, HIGHWATER and ALLCLEAR.





Left: Devices screen before discovery. Right: Add Device — select Other to discover.



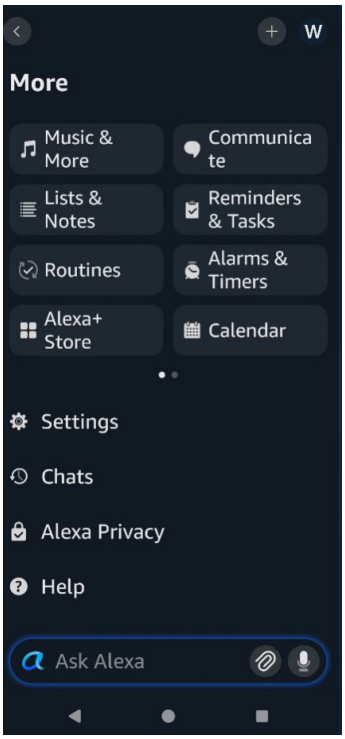
All Devices list after discovery — ALLCLEAR, FLOODING and HIGHWATER shown as Recently Added.

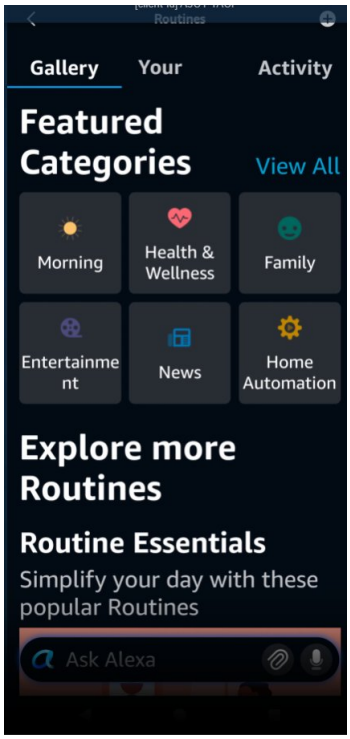
Section 5 — Alexa App: Create the FLOODING Routine

The FLOODING routine is the heart of the alert system. When the FLOODING contact sensor opens, Alexa sets the volume, plays the Claxion3 alarm, and announces a voice message across all Echo devices.

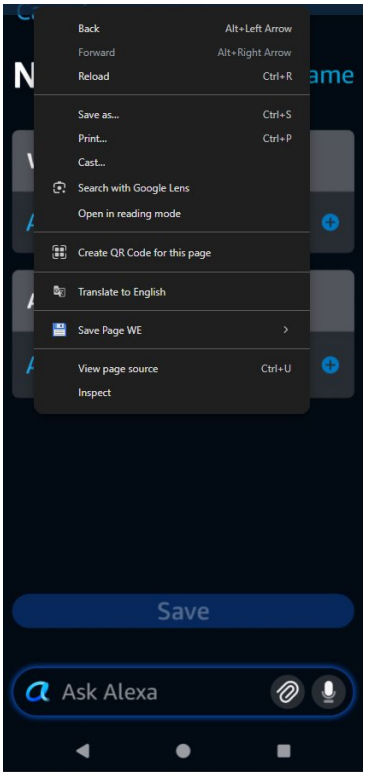
5.1 Open Routines

- Tap **More** → **Routines**.
- Tap the **+ (plus)** icon to create a new routine.
- Tap **Rename** and name it: **FLOODING opens**.





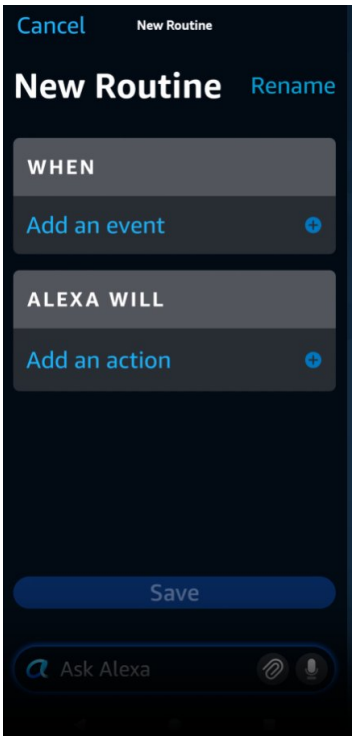
Left: Routines Gallery. Right: Your routines tab — tap + to add new.

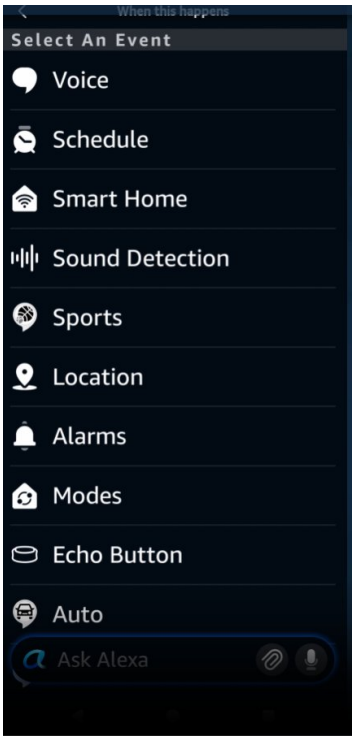


New Routine screen — tap Rename then Add an event.

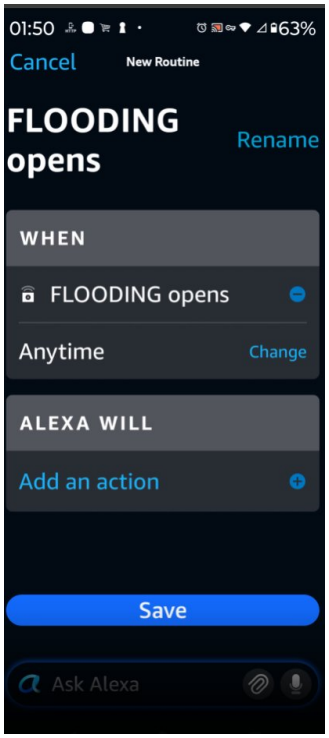
5.2 Set the Trigger (WHEN)

- Under **WHEN** tap **Add an event**.
- Select **Smart Home** from the event list.
- Choose **Contact Sensor** → select **Open**.
- Select **FLOODING** from the device list.
- Leave timing as **Anytime** then tap **Next**.





Left: Add Event screen. Right: Select An Event — choose Smart Home.



Left: Contact Sensor — select Open. Right: FLOODING trigger confirmed.

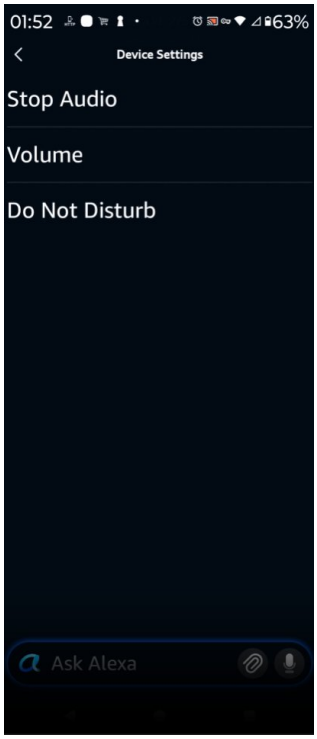
5.3 Add Actions (ALEXA WILL)

Under **ALEXA WILL** tap **Add an action** and add the following three actions **in order**:

#	Action Type	Setting
1	Device Settings → Volume	Set volume to 5
2	Music → My Media	"Alexa, ask My Media to play Claxion3.mp3"
3	Messaging → Send Announcement	"Sump pit flooding take immediate action"

5.3a Action 1 — Set Volume

- Tap **Add an action** → **Device Settings** → **Volume**.
- Set volume to **5** and tap **Next**.



Device Settings — select Volume to set alert volume level.

5.3b Action 2 — Play Claxion3 via My Media

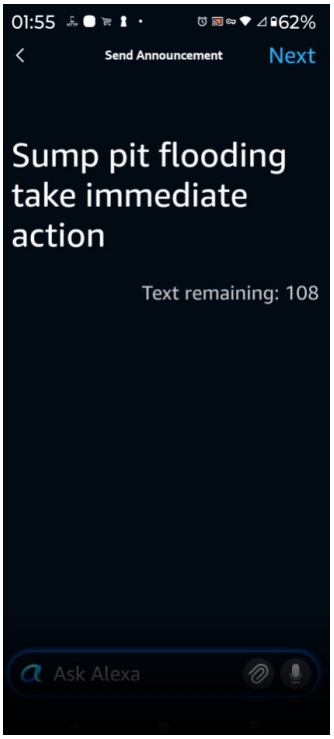
- Tap **Add an action** → **Custom Action**.
- Type: **Alexa, ask My Media to play Claxion3.mp3**
- Tap **Next**.

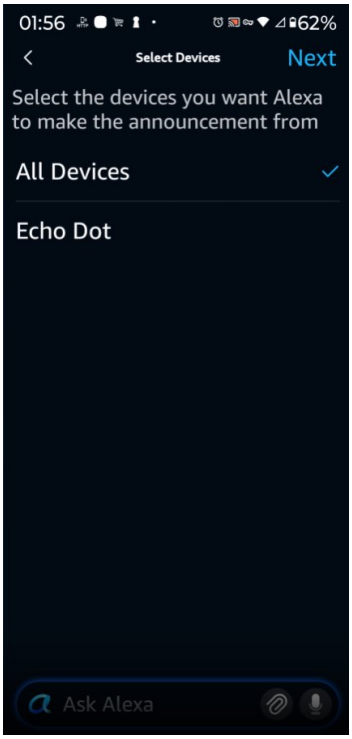
■ *The Claxion3.mp3 file must exist in your My Media watch folder on the Raspberry Pi.*

5.3c Action 3 — Send Announcement

- Tap **Add an action** → **Messaging** → **Send Announcement**.
- Type: **Sump pit flooding take immediate action**

- Tap **Next**.



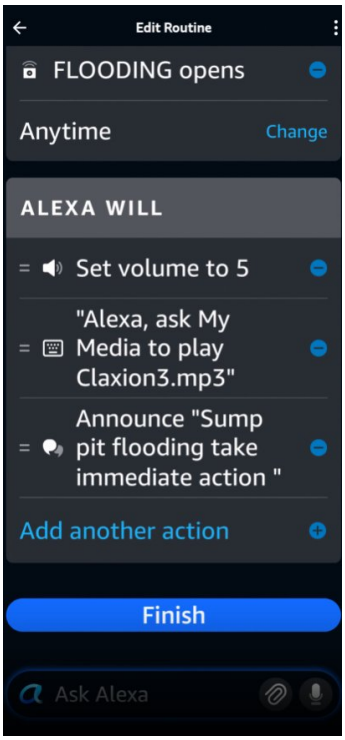


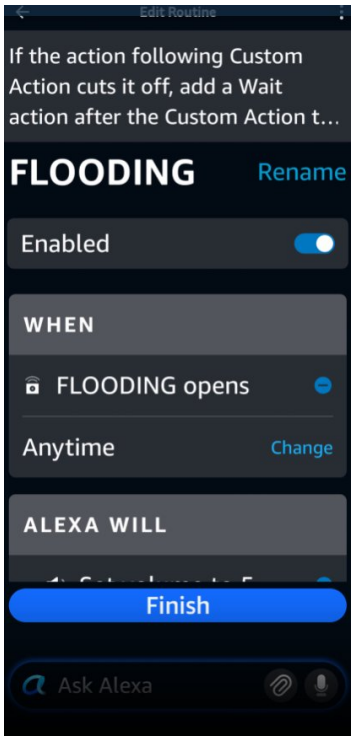
Left: Announcement text entry. Right: Select All Devices for announcement.

■ *Select **All Devices** so the alert plays on all 4 Echo devices simultaneously.*

5.4 Complete Routine

The completed ALEXA WILL section should show all three actions. Tap **Finish** to save.





Left: ALEXA WILL actions — Volume, My Media, Announce. Right: Completed FLOODING routine ready to save.

Section 6 — My Media for Alexa: Raspberry Pi Setup

My Media for Alexa is required to play the Claxion3.mp3 alarm sound. It runs as a local server on a Raspberry Pi and streams your media files to Alexa on demand.

Why Raspberry Pi for 24/7 Operation?

Reason	Detail
Low Power	Draws only ~3-5W — far less than a full PC running continuously
Cool Running	No heat issues — safe for always-on basement/utility room use
Docker Compose	My Media runs as a container — easy to deploy and auto-restart
Set and Forget	Boots and runs automatically — no babysitting required

For complete Raspberry Pi installation instructions see the official guide:

https://www.mymediaalexa.com/home/raspberrypi

■ *Ensure the Claxion3.mp3 file is placed in your My Media watch folder and that My Media has indexed it before testing the routine.*

Section 7 — Testing the Setup

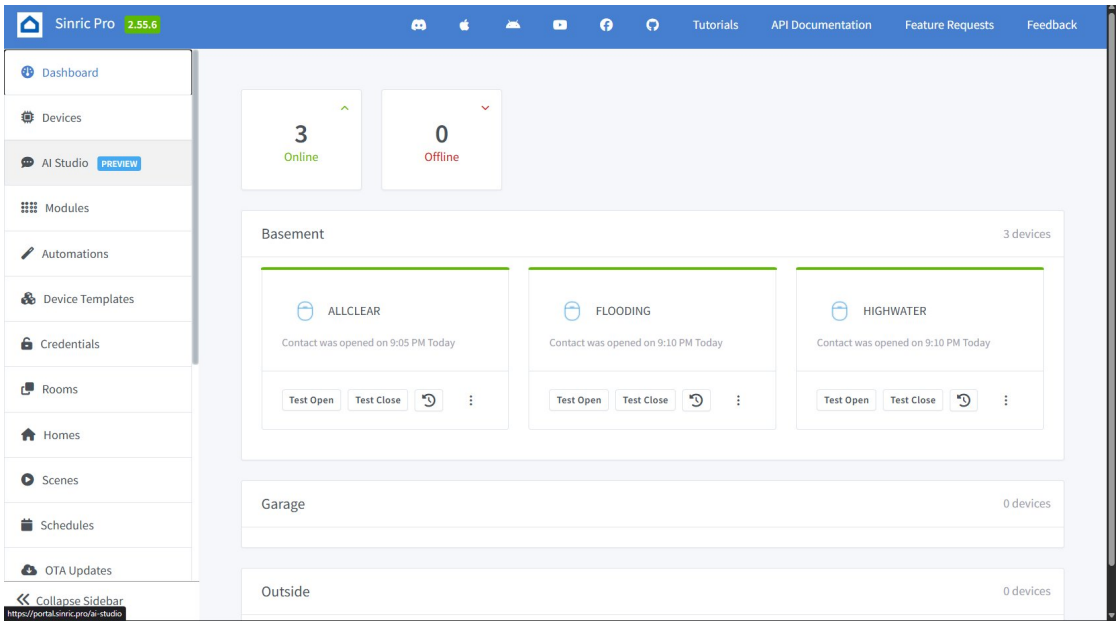
Verify the complete alert chain works before relying on the system.

7.1 Test via Alexa App (Manual Trigger)

- In the Alexa app go to **More** → **Routines**.
- Tap the **Your** tab and find **FLOODING opens**.
- Tap the **Play** ■ button to manually trigger the routine.
- Confirm: volume changes, Claxion3 alarm plays, announcement heard on all devices.

7.2 Test via SinricPro Dashboard

- In the SinricPro dashboard find the **FLOODING** device card.
- Tap **Test Open** — Alexa should trigger the routine within seconds.
- Tap **Test Close** after testing to reset the sensor state.



SinricPro Dashboard — use Test Open / Test Close buttons to verify sensor triggers.

■ *If the routine does not trigger: verify the SinricPro skill is still enabled in Alexa, confirm the FLOODING device shows Online (green) in SinricPro, and check that My Media server is running on the Raspberry Pi.*